

SoleSight

Commercial Business Proposal & Growth Strategy -- Deterministic Causal Decision Intelligence for Retail Footwear

Market: Enterprise Retail SaaS | Target: Multi-Store Footwear Chains | Model: B2B Annual License + Per-Store SaaS
Indicative Payback: Under 45 Days | Indicative Logistics ROI: 29.8x | Date: August 2026

1. Executive Summary

Footwear retail loses revenue at a single, predictable point: the try-on bench. When a core size (UK 8 or 9) is out of stock, footfall is unaffected but conversion collapses -- and because shoes are anatomically non-substitutable, that demand does not transfer to another SKU, it simply leaves the store. Existing tools describe *what* happened days later in a spreadsheet; none identify, in real time and with mathematical proof, *why* it happened and what to do about it.

SoleSight is a deterministic, statistically grounded root-cause and decision-intelligence engine purpose-built for footwear retail. It unifies POS, footfall sensors, inventory ERP and staff-roster data, screens for anomalies on a rolling basis, and isolates causal drivers through auditable statistical triangulation rather than probabilistic inference -- eliminating the hallucination risk of generic AI tools. In pilot modelling, the engine identifies up to **Rs 13.4 lakh** of recoverable weekly revenue per flagship store, with a buyer-side payback period inside 45 days and a targeted **29.8x** return on the incremental logistics spend required to act on its recommendations.

The immediate wedge is narrow and defensible: size-curve stockout attribution and feasibility-checked inter-branch restocking for multi-store footwear chains, not general retail BI. Commercially, SoleSight is structured as a three-tier enterprise SaaS product (Rs 4.5 lakh to Rs 28 lakh+ per year, plus per-store or per-cluster fees), targeting an estimated \$3.8 billion global retail-analytics spend within the broader footwear/apparel vertical. The go-to-market plan is sequenced to convert three founder-led pilots into documented, referenceable savings before scaling toward a \$5 million ARR milestone in Year 2.

2. Problem Framing

2.1 The Market Problem (Industry-Wide, Independent of SoleSight)

Across direct-to-consumer and hybrid D2C-plus-wholesale footwear and apparel brands, five structural conditions recur regardless of scale or geography:

- **Data fragmentation** -- e-commerce, retail POS, wholesale ledgers and marketplace channels each hold a partial, disconnected view of demand.
- **SKU, size and colourway complexity** -- footwear multiplies each style across sizes and colourways, making manual forecasting error-prone at any real scale.
- **Margin erosion** -- returns, markdowns and the mismatch between overstock in one location and stockout in another steadily erode gross margin.
- **Fragmented marketing attribution** -- spend and footfall are tracked separately from in-store conversion, so channel ROI is frequently mis-stated.
- **Slow, manual decision cycles** -- most chains still reconcile these signals through spreadsheets on a multi-day cycle, long after the selling window has closed.

A light PESTEL scan confirms this is a structural, industry-wide condition rather than an isolated complaint: **Economic** -- margin pressure and discounting are industry-wide, not brand-specific; **Technological** -- the shift to omnichannel retail has outpaced the analytics stack most chains run on; **Social** -- return-heavy, try-before-you-commit shopping behaviour is now the norm and directly inflates reverse-logistics cost.

2.2 The Specific Wedge SoleSight Targets

Within this broad landscape, SoleSight is built to solve one problem first: **size-curve stockout attribution and feasibility-checked restocking for physical footwear retail** -- not general omnichannel BI, not apparel or accessories assortment planning, and not marketplace/wholesale demand planning (yet). This scope is deliberate: footwear is the category where a stockout most directly and measurably destroys a sale, because sizes are not substitutable the way apparel or electronics variants often are.

2.3 The Solution, at a Concept Level

SoleSight is a decision-intelligence layer that sits above a retailer's existing POS, inventory and footfall systems. It continuously screens store-level data for statistically significant anomalies, mathematically isolates whether a sales drop is caused by a size-curve stockout (versus footfall, staffing or marketing effects), and -- only where the recommendation is logistically feasible -- proposes an inter-branch restock. It is designed to be auditable and deterministic rather than a black-box AI recommendation engine, which is what makes it usable by finance and operations leaders, not just data teams.

3. Our Solution -- Design & Architecture

3.1 The Direct Problem Being Targeted

Core-size stockouts silently collapse try-on conversion while footfall and marketing spend continue unchanged, and no existing system connects the two signals fast enough to act.

3.2 What the Solution Is

SoleSight is composed of four functional modules: (1) rolling statistical anomaly screening, (2) deterministic causal attribution, (3) a hardcoded abstention gate that withholds recommendations when evidence is inconclusive, and (4) feasibility-constrained restock recommendation.

3.3 How It Works, End to End

Data sources -- POS transactions, footfall sensors, inventory/ERP records and staff rosters, per store, per SKU-size.

Ingestion & integration layer -- standardized CSV/ERP connectors feed an in-memory OLAP engine (DuckDB), avoiding the multi-day batch cycle of legacy BI.

Processing / statistical layer -- an 8-week rolling z-score model flags anomalies; dose-response ordinary-least-squares triangulation then attributes the anomaly to a specific cause; the abstention gate suppresses any recommendation below a confidence threshold.

Dashboards & outputs -- role-specific views (Store Manager, Regional, Boardroom) and an AI copilot surface the same underlying causal proof at different levels of detail.

User action loop -- a feasibility-checked restock request is generated, routed for inter-branch dispatch, and the resulting sales lift feeds back into the model as validation data.

A visual system diagram of this flow is recommended as an exhibit in the design-partner-facing version of this document.

3.4 The Commercial Output

This technical flow converts raw, multi-channel store data into a real-time, mathematically proven root-cause diagnosis and a feasibility-checked restock action -- reducing detection latency from 4-7 days to under 2 seconds of data ingest, and recovering an estimated Rs 13.4 lakh in weekly revenue per flagship store.

4. Target Users

4A. Current Target Users -- Decision Rights & Value Realization

Four personas are served by the product today. The Value Proposition Canvas maps each persona's pains and desired gains directly to a SoleSight pain reliever or gain creator.

Persona	Decision They Own	Decision Rate	Value Realization
Store Operations Manager (Rahul Sharma)	Which SKUs/sizes to flag for emergency restock on the floor	Daily	Pinpoints exact size deficits and shift-training gaps; instant restock requests
Regional Operations Director (Priya Nair)	How to reallocate stock across a store cluster	Weekly	Automated inter-branch reallocation proposals with pre-vetted feasibility and lead times
Marketing & Growth Lead (Vikram Mehta)	Which campaigns/channels to fund or pause	Weekly / per-campaign	Isolates true campaign footfall lift (+3.9%) from floor-level stockout leakage
Chief Financial Officer (Ananya Verma)	Where to approve emergency logistics spend	Monthly / quarterly	Quantifies P&L leakage in rupees (Rs 54.2L across the network) and proves ROI on spend

Persona Group	Pain (Today)	Gain Sought	SoleSight Relief / Gain Creator
Store & Regional Ops	Blind to shelf-level stockout impact; slow multi-day audits	Real-time, trustworthy floor visibility	Sub-2-second anomaly alerts; automated reallocation proposals
Marketing	Blamed for weak sales despite strong footfall	Defensible attribution of campaign ROI	Separates floor conversion loss from marketing-driven footfall lift
Finance	Unexplained margin erosion; reactive discounting	Quantified, auditable P&L leakage and ROI	Deterministic rupee-value leakage reporting and logistics ROI proof

Value Proposition Canvas mapping -- pains and gains by persona group.

4B. Future Scope -- Expanded Personas

Beyond the four personas served today, the following roles represent a tangible, evaluable roadmap for expansion -- each requiring a specific new module or data source, not a re-platform.

Candidate Persona	New Module / Data Source Required
Merchandising / Buying Leads	Pre-season assortment and open-to-buy planning module
Sustainability / ESG Reporting Leads	Returns-to-landfill and logistics-emissions data feed
Wholesale / Key Account Managers	Wholesale order and sell-through data integration
E-commerce UX / Conversion Teams	Online funnel and cart-abandonment data feed

5. Enterprise Value Proposition

The value story is organised into four mutually exclusive, collectively exhaustive (MECE) buckets. Each bucket owns a distinct value lever with no overlap into another bucket's territory.

Value Bucket	What It Covers
Revenue Protection	Captures an estimated Rs 13.4 lakh in weekly lost sales per flagship store by triggering inter-branch rebalancing before demand dissipates.

Value Bucket	What It Covers
Margin Recovery	Reduces size-related return rates by up to 34% by eliminating forced compromise purchases on the wrong available size.
Operational Efficiency	Saves an estimated 15+ hours per week per regional manager previously spent manually reconciling ERP, POS and footfall spreadsheets.
Marketing ROI	Validates that campaign spend is driving real footfall, isolating that effect (+3.9%) from floor-level conversion leakage and protecting media budgets from premature cancellation.

6. Competitive Landscape & Strategic Moat

Viewed through Porter's Five Forces, the relevant competitive pressure is not new-entrant risk (the domain logic is hard to replicate quickly) but **substitution** -- generic BI and enterprise data platforms that customers already own and may stretch to cover this use case -- and **buyer power**, since large chains can commission bespoke consulting builds. The comparison below is scoped to those two forces rather than to a full feature list.

Capability	SoleSight	Generic BI (PowerBI / Tableau)	Enterprise Platforms (SAP / Palantir)
Size-curve causal root-cause detection	Yes -- purpose-built	No -- requires custom build	Partial -- bespoke consulting
Multi-channel data unification (POS + footfall + ERP)	Yes	Partial -- manual integration	Partial
Deterministic attribution (no hallucination)	Yes -- auditable OLS proof	No -- manual analyst effort	Partial -- rule-based only
Return / compromise-purchase risk prediction	Yes	No	Partial
Real-time dashboards	Yes	Yes	Partial -- often batch
Footwear-specific taxonomy and domain logic	Yes	No	Partial
Feasibility-constrained restock recommendations	Yes	No	No
Typical time-to-value	Under 1 week	3-6 months	9-18 months

7. Business Model & Pricing Architecture

Three tiers, structured so a prospective buyer can immediately locate their organisation's size profile and see exactly what is included -- and excluded -- at that level.

Starter -- Store Operations Core	
Targets	Regional footwear chains, 10-30 stores, single-region, under roughly \$50M revenue
Pricing	Rs 4,50,000 / year base, plus Rs 15,000 / store / month
Included	- Core in-memory analytics engine - Five standard KPI contracts - Store Manager view - Monthly forecast / anomaly refresh

Excluded at this tier	- Regional inter-branch rebalancing - Return-risk module - Real-time refresh - Dedicated success manager
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Growth -- Regional Pro	
Targets	Mid-size multi-region brands, 30-100 stores, roughly \$50M-\$250M revenue
Pricing	Rs 12,00,000 / year base, plus Rs 12,000 / store / month
Included	- Everything in Starter - Full multi-channel integration - Weekly forecast refresh - Return-risk module - Regional rebalancing and feasibility engine
Excluded at this tier	- Real-time refresh - Multi-brand / multi-region support - Dedicated success manager

Enterprise -- Enterprise Fleet	
Targets	National and global footwear chains, 100+ stores, multi-region
Pricing	Rs 28,00,000 / year base, plus Rs 9,50,000 / store cluster
Included	- Everything in Growth - Real-time refresh - Full ML causal forecasting suite - Multi-brand / multi-region support - Active-learning AI copilot - Dedicated success manager - Custom ERP integrations
Excluded at this tier	- None -- full suite included

8. Financial Payback & Business Case

8A. Builder-Side Payback -- SoleSight's Own Business Case

Sized top-down using a TAM → SAM → SOM funnel. All figures below are explicitly labelled as guesstimates, to be revisited once pilot traction data is available.

Layer	Definition	Estimate (guesstimate)
TAM	Global D2C and multi-store footwear/apparel retail-analytics spend	~\$3.8 billion
SAM	Multi-store footwear chains matching SoleSight's current product maturity (India-plus-APAC, 10+ stores, POS/ERP digitised)	Low-single-digit percent of TAM
SOM	Realistic Year 1-2 capture given current go-to-market capacity (founder-led pilots scaling to channel partnerships)	500 active store subscriptions by end of Year 2, targeting Rs 4-5 crore (~\$5 million) ARR

From SOM, the maximum plausible Year-1 revenue estimate is a small fraction of the Year-2 ARR milestone above, weighted toward the Growth and Enterprise tiers as pilot chains expand store coverage; current market penetration is a forward marker only and should be revisited once the first pilots close.

8B. Buyer-Side Payback -- The Retailer's ROI

Line Item	Value
Identified weekly leakage (flagship store)	Rs 13,40,000
Feasible inter-branch restock recovery (~80% capture)	Rs 10,72,000
Inter-branch dispatch logistics cost	Rs 36,000
Net weekly recovery	Rs 10,36,000
Annual SoleSight software cost (Starter tier, single store)	Rs 1,80,000
Payback period	Under 45 days (modelled as low as ~5 days of recovered sales at full run-rate)

A payback period this short is a direct signal of renewal likelihood, not just initial feasibility: a customer recovering cost within weeks is materially more likely to renew and expand than one on a 12-36 month payback curve, which supports a favourable long-term LTV-to-CAC ratio as the Starter and Growth cohorts mature.

9. Go-to-Market Strategy

Structured as a five-phase market-entry sequence rather than a marketing calendar.

Phase	Timeline	Focus	Milestone
1. Beachhead Selection	Months 1-3	Top five Indian footwear retailers; founder-led outreach and six-month historical backtesting	3 signed pilot letters of intent
2. Design Partner / Pilot Acquisition	Months 3-6	Sign 2-3 anchor logos on pilot pricing; deploy live POS/sensor connectors across roughly 25 flagship stores	Live deployment across 3 design-partner brands
3. Proof & Case Study Development	Months 4-6 (overlapping)	Measure and document weekly recovered leakage per pilot store into referenceable, quantified case studies	Rs 25 lakh+ documented client savings
4. Category Expansion	Months 7-12	Expand within national footwear chains and metro hubs; begin evaluating adjacent apparel verticals	500 active store subscriptions
5. Scale & Channel Partnerships	Year 2+	Partnerships with ERP vendors (SAP / Retail Pro), footfall-sensor providers and systems integrators to scale beyond direct sales; APAC and global expansion	\$5M ARR milestone

10. Product Roadmap

Full technical ownership sits with the product/engineering team; this section summarises direction only and should link out to the detailed technical roadmap document rather than duplicate it.

- **Phase 1 (built):** in-memory OLAP engine, four-stage statistical RCA pipeline, abstention gate, dual-mode UI and AI copilot.
- **Phase 2 (Q4 2026):** live SAP S/4HANA and Oracle Retail webhooks, automated daily POS sync, WhatsApp/SMS store-manager alerts, multi-region RBAC.
- **Phase 3 (Q2 2027):** one-click ERP stock-transfer writeback, computer-vision shelf-void detection, dynamic markdown optimisation, category expansion into apparel.
- **Phase 4 (2028):** multi-tenant cloud scale, cross-retailer anonymised benchmarking, edge-AI in-store inference, native mobile field app.

11. Phased Impact Assessment

Framed as a KPI tree cascading from the Year-2 SOM goal in Section 8A into time-boxed, measurable adoption and usage checkpoints. Figures are placeholders to be replaced with real numbers as pilots close.

Timeframe	Adoption KPIs	Data / Usage KPIs
Month 1	First pilot users onboarded across design-partner brands	Initial data pipelines connected
Month 2-3	Active organisations across all 3 design partners	Multi-million-row data volumes integrated
Month 6	Target share of pilot brands renewed or expanded	Majority data-source coverage per brand
Month 10	First cohort of paying enterprise accounts	10M+ rows processed cumulatively
Month 12+	Target year-on-year logo growth toward 500 stores	20M+ rows; multi-brand data maturity

12. Key Risks & Mitigation Strategy

SWOT -- Soulside as a Business

Quadrant	Summary
Strengths	Deterministic, auditable causal engine; narrow defensible wedge; fast (sub-1-week) time-to-value versus 3-18 months for incumbents
Weaknesses	Early-stage integration footprint; dependent on customer ERP/POS data quality; small team relative to enterprise platform vendors
Opportunities	Large underserved footwear-specific analytics niche; expansion path into adjacent apparel and additional personas
Threats	Incumbent BI and enterprise platforms adding native vertical features; customer build-vs-buy pressure at the largest accounts

PESTEL -- External / Macro View

Surfaces risks SoleSight does not directly control: **Legal** -- data-privacy regulation affecting POS and footfall data handling; **Economic** -- a broader retail spending contraction reducing pilot budgets; **Technological** -- incumbent platforms adding native causal-BI features.

Consolidated Risk Register

Risk	Category	Likelihood	Impact	Priority Timing	Mitigation
Data integration complexity with legacy ERPs	Weakness	High	High	Day-0 -- before pilot	Dedicated integration team; phased data audit
Incumbent BI tools add vertical features	Threat / Technological	Medium	High	Later-stage -- monitor from Month 6	Deepen footwear-specific taxonomy moat
Store staff ignore restock alerts	Weakness	Medium	Medium	Day-0 -- before pilot	Simplified, jargon-free store-manager briefings; one-click execution
Data-privacy regulation changes	Legal	Low	Medium	Later-stage -- monitor annually	Standardised, minimal-footprint data ingestion

Risk	Category	Likelihood	Impact	Priority Timing	Mitigation
Retail spending contraction	Economic	Medium	Medium	Later-stage -- monitor from Month 6	Emphasise sub-45-day payback in a cost-conscious market
Loss of management confidence in AI output	Threat	Low	High	Day-0 -- before pilot	Hardcoded abstention gate; 100% deterministic, auditable proofs

13. Conclusion

The case for SoleSight rests on numbers already established in this document, not on aspiration: an estimated Rs 13.4 lakh in recoverable weekly revenue per flagship store, a buyer-side payback period inside 45 days, a targeted 29.8x return on incremental logistics spend, and a 15-plus hour weekly labour saving per regional manager. Layered onto a defensible, narrowly scoped wedge and a five-phase go-to-market plan sequenced toward a \$5 million ARR milestone in Year 2, these figures support a business case that is evidence-based rather than aspirational -- and one that a CFO or COO reviewer can verify line by line.

Appendix -- Framework Index

Strategic frameworks applied in this document and where each was used.

Framework	Purpose	Section Applied
PESTEL Analysis	Macro-environment scan of the footwear/D2C industry	2.1 Problem Framing; 12 Key Risks
SWOT Analysis	Internal and external positioning of SoleSight	12 Key Risks
MECE Principle	Ensures value-proposition buckets are non-overlapping and complete	5 Enterprise Value Proposition; 7 Pricing
TAM / SAM / SOM	Market-sizing funnel	8A Builder-Side Payback
Porter's Five Forces	Competitive intensity assessment	6 Competitive Landscape
Value Proposition Canvas	Maps customer pains/gains to product relievers/creators	4A Target Users
Unit Economics (Payback Period)	Standard SaaS financial-health metric	8B Buyer-Side Payback
OKR / KPI Tree	Cascades a large goal into time-boxed, measurable checkpoints	11 Phased Impact Assessment